Ethiopia had a long sea accesses that stretches 1000 KM from Ras Kassar to Ras Dumera. It also had two ports (Assab and Massawa), which were equipped with modern infrastructure. Unfortunately, due to irresponsible and bigotry leaders, it lost them all and become land locked.

For almost three decades, raising the importance of sea accesses/port was considered as a taboo. In certain political discourses, when brave individuals used to raise this issue, especially the historical ownership of Assab Port, EPRDF/TPLF cadres used to ridicule them as expansionists who claim Eritrea's sovereignty.

Recently, thanks to PM Abiy who have been boldly speaking the significance and urgent need of sea accesses for this great nation with a population of more than 130 million and a booming economy in Africa, the issue is becoming a hot agendum among all Ethiopians. This radical shift to me who lived and knew Assab very well gives immense pleasure.

My intention here is simply to share you some facts about Assab.

Fact 1: The Town

Assab is a historical city located at the coast of Red Sea. It is dry and hot. Its weather gets extreme hot from June to September. There were only a few apartments which were built by Italians; majority of the houses were either flat buildings or small cottage like ones. The town has three sub cities named Assab Kebir, Assab saqir and Cambo Sudan. Assab kebir is the main sub city in which the port, the administrative offices and most hotels were found. Assab saqir on the other hand, is relatively small one and located on the north east of the town. In Assab Saqir, most of the residents were from Afar Tribes. Cambo Sudan was the area where most of the inhabitants of the town reside. More than 95% of the residents were Ethiopians, of which majority were from Wollo. Eritreans accounted less than 5%. Assab had road access only to Ethiopian towns. There was no any road access from Assab to any of Eritrean towns. Assab had strong communication with Ethiopian towns like Burie, Manda, Dufti, Kombolcha, Dessie and others. Agricultural products like cereals, fruits, vegetables and others were transported from Kombolcha, Dessie and Dufti. In the coming pieces of writings, I'll try to share you some important issues about the port, the refinery, the naval base, the islands, and other economic infrastructures.